27 Oct 2026 09:37:50 ET | 13 pages

Poya (5904.TWO)

Strong 3Q as Expected; Tougher Comparisons Ahead

CITI'S TAKE

Poya's 3Q26 net profit +26% y/y came largely in-line with our forecast, and 5% ahead of BBG consensus. SSSG of 7.0%, higher GPM, opex savings and stronger op leverage lifted OPM to 17.5%, the key drivers to strong profitability. Looking into 4Q, tougher comp should moderate sales and earnings growth despite fast store additions and solid operation execution. We maintain Neutral as the strong share price rally YTD appears to reflect most positives from robust SSSG and margin expansion. A higher comp base and potentially intensifying competition limit the room for further re-rating.

3Q26 broadly in-line; solid margins boosted by strong op leverage — Poya reported 3Q26 net profits of NT$1.0bn +26% y/y, largely in-line with our est and 5% above BBG's est. 3Q sales of NT$7.4bn +15% y/y were supported by solid SSSG +7.0% y/y with ticket size +4.9% and traffic +2.0%. Higher GPM, strong opex savings and op leverage lifted OPM to 17.5%, topping our/BBG est of 17.1%/16.6%. Total store count reached 495 at end-3Q26 (+25 net increase in 9M26).

4Q outlook: faster store expansion meets a higher comp base — We expect 30 net store additions in 4Q26E vs. 35 stores prior, bringing the year-end store count to 525 and supporting continued sales growth. Demand for beauty-related products remains healthy. However, the elevated comparison base from 4Q26E onward should moderate SSSG and overall sales and earnings growth, despite the contribution from new stores. We believe this potential growth deceleration could temper investor enthusiasm and trigger profit-taking pressure.

Implications: Slightly positive reaction expected; maintain Neutral — We keep our earnings estimates for 26-28E largely unchanged in view of the in-line 3Q results. We expect a slightly positive market reaction to the results given the healthy margin expansion. However, strong sales had likely raised expectations for 3Q profitability, limiting the scope for a more meaningful positive surprise. Our Neutral thesis remains unchanged – we believe the strong share price rally has priced in much of the benefit from robust SSSG and margin improvement. Looking ahead, tougher comp could constrain growth, while potentially intensifying competition, including Cosmed's introduction of Olive Young products, could challenge Poya's beauty-led momentum. We therefore see limited room for further re-rating despite solid operating execution.

Earnings Summary

Year to 31 Dec	Net Profit (NT$M)	Diluted EPS (NT$)	EPS growth (%)	P/E (x)	P/B (x)	ROE (%)	Yield (%)
2024A	2,804	26.72	9.5	2.7	1.1	41.6	31.6
2025A	3,143	29.52	10.5	2.5	1.0	41.2	35.1
2026E	4,005	3.76	-87.3	19.3	8.9	47.8	4.5
2027E	4,366	4.10	9.0	17.7	8.4	48.8	4.9
2028E	4,714	4.43	8.0	16.4	7.8	49.2	5.3

Source: Powered by dataCentral

Neutral

Price (27 Oct 26 15:00)	NT$72.70
Target price	NT$70.00
Expected share price return	-3.7%
Expected dividend yield	5.0%
Expected total return	1.3%
Market Cap	NT$77,385M
	US$2,375M

Price Performance
(RIC: 5904.TWO, BB: 5904 TT)



Angela Hsu[AC]
+886-2-8726-9083
angela.hc.hsu@citi.com

5904.TWO: Fiscal year end 31-Dec						Price: NT$72.70; TP: NT$70.00; Market Cap: NT$77,395m; Recomm: Neutral					
Profit & Loss (NT$m)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**	**Valuation ratios**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Sales revenue	23,628	25,320	28,588	31,083	33,587	PE (x)	2.7	2.5	19.3	17.7	16.4
Cost of sales	-12,962	-13,873	-15,350	-16,698	-18,050	PB (x)	1.1	1.0	8.9	8.4	7.8
Gross profit	10,666	11,447	13,238	14,385	15,537	EV/EBITDA (x)	14.4	13.2	11.1	10.3	9.6
Gross Margin (%)	45.1	45.2	46.3	46.3	46.3	FCF yield (%)	55.1	63.4	9.2	8.2	9.0
EBITDA (Adj)	**6,155**	**6,783**	**7,981**	**8,501**	**9,032**	Dividend yield (%)	31.6	35.1	4.5	4.9	5.3
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	26.1	26.8	27.9	27.3	26.9	Payout ratio (%)	86	86	86	86	86
Depreciation	-2,707	-2,908	-2,995	-3,085	-3,178	ROE (%)	41.6	41.2	47.8	48.8	49.2
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	**Cashflow (NT$m)**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
EBIT (Adj)	**3,448**	**3,875**	**4,986**	**5,416**	**5,854**	EBITDA	6,155	6,783	7,981	8,501	9,032
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	14.6	15.3	17.4	17.4	17.4	Working capital	-378	-579	962	-200	-57
Net interest	0	0	0	0	0	Other	-412	-305	-841	-943	-1,033
Associates	0	0	0	0	0	**Operating cashflow**	**5,365**	**5,898**	**8,102**	**7,358**	**7,942**
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	58	48	15	36	32	Capex	-1,162	-995	-995	-995	-995
Pre-tax profit	**3,506**	**3,923**	**5,000**	**5,451**	**5,886**	Net acq/disposals	13	11	9	9	9
Tax	-702	-781	-996	-1,085	-1,172	Other	-166	-164	-10	-10	-10
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	0	0	0	0	0	**Investing cashflow**	**-1,316**	**-1,147**	**-996**	**-996**	**-996**
Reported net profit	**2,804**	**3,143**	**4,005**	**4,366**	**4,714**	Dividends paid	-2,173	-2,414	-3,457	-3,769	-4,069
Net Margin (%)	11.9	12.4	14.0	14.0	14.0	**Financing cashflow**	**-3,209**	**-3,912**	**-5,304**	**-5,670**	**-6,026**
Core NPAT	2,804	3,143	4,005	4,366	4,714	**Net change in cash**	**840**	**839**	**1,802**	**692**	**921**
Per share data	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**	**Free cashflow to s/holders**	**4,203**	**4,903**	**7,107**	**6,363**	**6,947**
Reported EPS ($)	26.72	29.52	3.76	4.10	4.43						
Core EPS ($)	26.72	29.52	3.76	4.10	4.43						
DPS ($)	23.00	25.50	3.25	3.54	3.82						
CFPS ($)	51.12	55.41	7.61	6.91	7.46						
FCFPS ($)	40.05	46.06	6.68	5.98	6.53						
BVPS ($)	68.17	76.17	8.13	8.69	9.30						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	105	106	1,064	1,064	1,064						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	105	106	1,064	1,064	1,064						
Growth rates	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**						
Sales revenue (%)	7.0	7.2	12.9	8.7	8.1						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	8.0	12.4	28.7	8.6	8.1						
Core NPAT (%)	11.0	12.1	27.4	9.0	8.0						
Core EPS (%)	9.5	10.5	-87.3	9.0	8.0						
Balance Sheet (NT$m)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**						
Cash & cash equiv.	2,834	3,673	5,476	6,168	7,088						
Accounts receivables	1,497	1,594	1,487	1,616	1,747						
Inventory	5,979	6,809	5,601	5,861	6,085						
Net fixed & other tangibles	18,195	19,525	19,332	19,103	18,837						
Goodwill & intangibles	0	0	0	0	0						
Financial & other assets	59	57	57	57	57						
Total assets	**28,564**	**31,659**	**31,952**	**32,805**	**33,814**						
Accounts payable	3,445	3,796	3,443	3,632	3,930						
Short-term debt	1,446	2,210	2,210	2,210	2,210						
Long-term debt	13,196	13,832	13,791	13,750	13,709						
Provisions & other liab	3,325	3,712	3,852	3,959	4,067						
Total liabilities	**21,411**	**23,550**	**23,296**	**23,552**	**23,915**						
Shareholders' equity	7,153	8,108	8,656	9,254	9,898						
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0						
Total equity	**7,153**	**8,108**	**8,656**	**9,254**	**9,898**						
Net debt (Adj)	**11,807**	**12,368**	**10,525**	**9,792**	**8,831**						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	165.1	152.5	121.6	105.8	89.2						

For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

Figure 1. Poya: 3Q26 Results Comp

Poya (5904-TW): Result Comparison

NT$ mn	3Q26	2Q26	Q/Q	3Q25	Y/Y	3Q26 Citi	Diff	3Q26 BBG	Diff
Revenue	7,359	6,932	*6%*	6,401	*15%*	7,291	*1%*	7,234	*2%*
Gross profit	3,433	3,115	*10%*	2,938	*17%*	3,399	*1%*	3,329	*3%*
Operating profit	1,289	1,068	*21%*	1,002	*29%*	1,248	*3%*	1,200	*7%*
Net profit	1,016	868	*17%*	808	*26%*	1,005	*1%*	963	*5%*
Basic EPS (NT$)	0.95	0.82	*17%*	0.76	*26%*	0.94	*1%*	0.92	*4%*
Ratio									
Gross margin (%)	46.6	44.9	*1.7*	45.9	*0.7*	46.6	*0.0*	46.0	*0.6*
Operating margin (%)	17.5	15.4	*2.1*	15.7	*1.9*	17.1	*0.4*	16.6	*0.9*
Net margin (%)	13.8	12.5	*1.3*	12.6	*1.2*	13.8	*0.0*	13.3	*0.5*

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Source: Bloomberg, Company Reports, Citi Research, Citi Research Estimates

Figure 2. Poya: Earnings Estimates Revisions

Poya (5904-TW): Earning Revision

	2026E			2027E			2028E		
NT$ mn	New	Old	Chg	New	Old	Chg	New	Old	Chg
Revenue	28,588	28,588	*0%*	31,083	31,225	*0%*	33,587	33,710	*0%*
Gross profit	13,238	13,236	*0%*	14,385	14,447	*0%*	15,537	15,590	*0%*
OPEX	8,252	8,278	*0%*	8,969	9,038	*-1%*	9,683	9,749	*-1%*
Operating profit	4,986	4,958	*1%*	5,416	5,409	*0%*	5,854	5,841	*0%*
Pre-tax profit	5,000	5,000	*0%*	5,451	5,446	*0%*	5,886	5,875	*0%*
Net profit	4,005	4,004	*0%*	4,366	4,362	*0%*	4,714	4,705	*0%*
Basic EPS (NT$)	3.76	3.76	*0%*	4.10	4.10	*0%*	4.43	4.42	*0%*
Ratio	New	Old	*diffi*	NeU	Old	*diffi*	NeU	Old	*diffi*
Gross margin (%)	46.3	46.3	*0.0*	46.3	46.3	*0.0*	46.3	46.2	*0.0*
OPEX to Sales ratio (%)	28.9	29.0	*-0.1*	28.9	28.9	*-0.1*	28.8	28.9	*-0.1*
Operating margin (%)	17.4	17.3	*0.1*	17.4	17.3	*0.1*	17.4	17.3	*0.1*
Net margin (%)	14.0	14.0	*0.0*	14.0	14.0	*0.1*	14.0	14.0	*0.1*

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Source: Citi Research, Citi Research Estimates

Bull/Bear: Poya (5904.TWO)

NT$ 82.00 ▲13% Upside | NT$ 70.00 ▼3.7% Downside | NT$ 52.00 ▼28% Downside



Spread 41pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 27 Oct 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Sales growth of 15-17% in 2026E
- OPM of 17.5-18.0% in 2026E
- Implied NTM P/E 21x

BASE Assumptions

- Sales growth of 10-15% in 2026E
- OPM of 17-17.5% in 2026E
- Implied NTM P/E 18x

BEAR Assumptions

- Sales growth of 5-10% in 2026E
- OPM of 15.5-16% in 2026E
- Implied NTM P/E 14x

Poya

Company description

Poya is the largest retailer of fast-moving consumer goods in Taiwan, focusing on low-priced cosmetics, accessories, clothing and food products for females aged 15-49. Poya had 470 stores in Taiwan at the end of 2025 and believes that the market can accommodate up to 700-800 stores before reaching saturation.

Investment strategy

We have a Neutral rating on Poya. We think YTD rally has baked in most positives, including strong SSSG and solid margin expansion. While fundamentals remain solid, tougher comparisons from 4Q26E could moderate this year's 6-7% SSSG, lowering operating leverage and capping further earnings upside. Meanwhile, Cosmed's expanding rollout of Olive Young brands is intensifying competition for beauty spending. Although Poya's SSSG has remained resilient, braoder distribution of these brands could divert customer traffic and increase promotional pressure. We continue to recognize Poya's execution in store expansion and ongoing efficiency improvements. However, with these strengths largely reflected in the share price and growth momentum facing a higher hurdle from 4Q26E onward, we see a more balanced risk/reward.

Valuation

We derive our 12-month target price of NT$70 for Poya from a DCF valuation method. Our assumptions include a terminal growth rate of 4.5% and WACC of 10.1% (beta of 1.05; risk-free rate of 4%; risk premium of 7.0%; cost of equity of 11.3%). Our target price implies a P/E of 18x on our NTM EPS.

Risks

Key downside risks that could mean the shares fail to achieve our target price include: intense price competition among online retailers, slower store traffic, margin dilution due to aggressive store expansion, and a soft macro environment.

Key upside risks that could mean the shares fail to achieve our target price include: easing price competition among online retailers, stronger store traffic, margin expansion thanks to strong cost control, and a stronger macro environment.

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Appendix A-1

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Poya (5904.TWO)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Angela Hsu



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	28-Feb-24 08:21:35	1	*60.29	48.52
2	08-May-24 07:52:30	1	*58.82	49.21
3	29-Jul-24 10:35:16	1	*58.42	50.69
4	30-Jul-25 08:12:33	1	*56.50	46.50
5	27-Apr-26 12:23:00	1	*63.00	52.20
6	27-Jul-26 06:55:55	1	*74.50	66.80
7	16-Sep-26 09:22:21	*2	*70.00	73.60

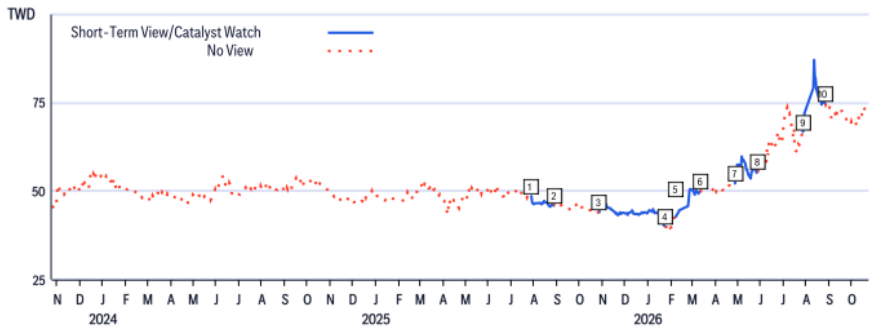
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Poya (5904.TWO)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Angela Hsu



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	28-Jul-25 04:46:55	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	48.55
2	27-Aug-25 22:13:12	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	45.90
3	27-Oct-25 03:28:53	Add STV	Upside	90 Days	44.00
4	25-Jan-26 20:18:18	Remove STV	Upside	90 Days	40.05
5	08-Feb-26 22:16:30	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	42.65
6	11-Mar-26 22:16:35	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	50.00
7	27-Apr-26 08:23:00	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	52.20
8	27-May-26 22:22:55	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	55.70
9	27-Jul-26 02:55:55	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	66.80
10	26-Aug-26 22:05:40	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	74.80

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
Data current as of 01 Oct 2026	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**	**Buy**	**Hold**	**Sell**
Citi Research Global Fundamental Coverage (Neutral=Hold)	61%	32%	7%	36%	48%	16%
% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	39%	43%	30%	42%	38%	36%

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